

DOTA 2: THE MOST PROFITABLE TITLE IN ESPORTS

The classic MOBA, whose flagship event is The International, had a **record-breaking** \$40 million prize pool in the 2021 edition, while its esports players earn the highest in the world

Neeladri Bhattacharjee
neeladri.b@thehindu.co.in

DOTA 2, one of the most popular esports titles in the world, is the most profitable title in the world, according to popular analytics firm Esports Charts.

The classic MOBA, whose flagship event is The International, had a record-breaking \$40 million prize pool in the 2021 edition, while its esports players earn the highest in the world. Johan 'n0tail' Sundstein is the top earner, with prize money going over \$7.18 million.

Though the prize money of the International has fallen drastically in the last four years — from USD 40 million to USD 3,380,455 — primarily because Valve removed the game's Battle Pass, it continues to lead the charts.

MOST EXPENSIVE ESPORTS TITLES

- Fortnite: \$202.9 million
- Counter-Strike 2: \$162.8 million
- League of Legends: \$122 million
- Arena of Valor: \$111.5 million

ORANGUTAN'S RUN ENDS ON A SOUR NOTE

Indian esports team Orangutan had a rather anti-climactic end in the Player Unknown's Battlegrounds Mobile Global Championship 2025, finishing outside the top 11 and missing out on a spot in the Last Chance Qualifier (LCQ).

The Indian side, which had won Battlegrounds Mobile India Showdown (BMSD) 2025 to earn a spot in the Championship, impressed in the gauntlet stage, qualifying for the group phase.

The top three in the Championship directly qualified for the Grand Finals, and teams ranked fourth to 11th made it to the LCQ.

At the time of writing, Wolves Esports, InnerCircle Esports, Gen.G Esports, LOOPS Esports, AlterEgo, Team Falcons, Papara SuperMassive and 9z Team have qualified for the LCQ.

LATEST SEASON OF EPREMIER LEAGUE ANNOUNCED

The Premier League and Electronic Arts (EA) announced the latest season of the ePremier League, part of the EA Sports FC Pro circuit. In its eighth season, the competition boasts a £100,000 prize pool and guaranteed spots at the 2026 FC Pro World Championship.

The ePremier League will have three online Open Qualifiers running between November 26 and December 11, followed by playoffs from January 14 to 22. The competition will have a double-bracket elimination format, offering a direct pathway to the ePremier League's Group Stage.

The Group Stage of ePremier League runs from February 28 to March 1, where clubs will face off in one-versus-one matches before the Knockout Stage.

The final weekend of the season will have knockouts on March 28 and the finals on March 29.

COMO ENTERS ESPORTS SPACE

Italian top-flight club Como 1907 announced its entry into the esports scene with the launch of the Como Gaming Club. The club made headlines in recent times when Cesc Fabregas and Thierry Henry, both FIFA World Cup winners, became minority stakeholders of the club as it got promoted to Serie A last season.

In esports, it has now roped in FC Pro 24 World Champion Anders Vejrgang, looking for a similar fairytale off the field.